

ONE BALL. FOUR WORKOUTS.

The **Medicine Ball Workout Collection**: full body, core, partner and 50+ workouts you can do at home.

FULL BODY

CORE

PARTNER

50+

8

ILLUSTRATED
EXERCISE CARDS

4

PRINTABLE WORKOUTS

15–25 minutes each

1

BALL WEIGHT GUIDE

Adults, 50+ and kids

28

DAY PLAN & LOG

Track every session

ISSUE 03

ONE BALL, ZERO EXCUSES

Issue 01 showed you how to train. Issue 02 showed you how to keep progressing. This issue is about training anywhere, with one piece of equipment that fits under a sofa.

Inside are four complete workouts: full body, core, partner and family, and one built for adults over 50. Each takes 15 to 25 minutes and uses the same ball.

Every exercise has an illustrated card showing where to start and where to finish, so you can follow along without a video. Print the cards, stick them on the wall, and press play on the timer.

SB

SADIA BALOCH

Head Coach · 7+ years · 257+ clients

WHAT YOU NEED**1 medicine ball** (weight guide, p.04)**2 × 2 metres of space****A solid wall** (for passes)**A sturdy chair** (Workout 4)**A timer** (your phone works)**CONTENTS****03****WHY ONE BALL IS ENOUGH**

Power, rotation, research

04**CHOOSE YOUR BALL**

Types and weights

05**WARM-UP & SAFETY**

5 minutes, 6 rules

06**EXERCISE CARDS**

8 moves, illustrated

08**W1 · FULL-BODY CIRCUIT**

20 minutes

09**W2 · CORE 15**

15 minutes

10**W3 · PARTNER & FAMILY**

20 minutes, 2+ people

11**W4 · STRONG AT 50+**

20–25 minutes

12**COACH INTERVIEW**

Home, family, 50+

13**YOUR 4-WEEK PLAN**

Two tracks

14**6 FORM MISTAKES**

And the fixes

15**LOG, FAQ & SOURCES**

Pages 15–16

FEATURE

WHY ONE BALL IS ENOUGH

It squats, presses, twists and throws. That last one is the thing dumbbells can't do, and it matters more than you think.

4

WORKOUTS

8

ILLUSTRATED MOVES

15–25

MINUTES

1

BALL

A medicine ball looks like the simplest thing in any gym. That is its strength. One ball lets you squat, press, rotate, carry and throw, and **throwing** is something a dumbbell can't safely give you.

STRENGTH VS POWER

When you throw, you have to produce force fast. That quality is called power. Strength is how much force you can make; power is how quickly you can make it. Power is what lets you jump, catch yourself on a stumble or stand up from a low chair without thinking.

Research backs the ball as a power tool. In a 12-week study, young handball players who added medicine ball training gained more upper-body power than players who didn't.¹ Another study found six weeks of medicine ball work improved throwing speed in female handball players.²

NOT ONLY FOR ATHLETES

A 2022 meta-analysis of older adults found that power training, lifting quickly and lowering slowly, improved muscle power and speed-based everyday tasks more than traditional strength training.³ That is why Workout 4 asks you to stand up and push the ball away quickly, then lower with control.

ROTATION YOU CAN TRAIN

Most gym programs move forward and back. Woodchops, twists and side tosses train your trunk to turn and to resist turning, the way you do when you swing a bag into a car or pick up a child.

IT FITS THE GUIDELINES

The World Health Organization recommends muscle-strengthening activity on two or more days a week for adults, and balance plus strength work on three or more days for older adults.⁴ The four workouts here cover both.

¹ Ignjatovic et al., *J Strength Cond Res* (2012) · ² Raeder et al., *J Strength Cond Res* (2015) · ³ *Eur Rev Aging Phys Act* (2022) · ⁴ Bull et al., *WHO guidelines, Br J Sports Med* (2020) · Go deeper: [12 medicine ball exercises for beginners](#)

BEFORE YOU BUY

CHOOSE YOUR BALL

Three types look alike but behave differently. Pick the wrong one for slams and it bounces straight back at you.



MEDICINE BALL

MOST EXERCISES

Rubber shell with a grippy surface. Bounces a little. Use it for squats, twists, chops and wall passes.



SLAM BALL

SLAMS ONLY

Thick shell filled with sand, so it lands dead without bouncing. The only safe choice for ball slams.



WALL BALL

CATCHING & THROWS

Larger and soft. Easy to catch, so it suits partner throws, kids and high wall throws.

WHAT WEIGHT?

WHO	SQUATS, TWISTS, CHOPS	THROWS & PASSES
New to training	3–4 kg	2–3 kg
Trains regularly	4–6 kg	3–5 kg
Over 50 or returning	1–3 kg	1–2 kg
Kids under 12	0.5–1 kg, soft ball, adult supervising	
Slam ball (adults)	4–8 kg for slams only	

THE SPEED TEST

Do 10 wall passes. If the last three are clearly slower than the first three, the ball is too heavy for throwing.

BUYING JUST ONE?

A 3–4 kg rubber medicine ball covers every workout here except slams.

EVERY SESSION STARTS HERE

WARM-UP & SAFETY

THE 5-MINUTE WARM-UP

1:00**MARCH OR JOG IN PLACE**

Build to a light sweat

1:00**BALL HALOS**

Circle the ball slowly around your head, 5 each way

1:00**BODYWEIGHT SQUATS**

10 slow reps, full depth you can control

1:00**HIP HINGES**

10 reps, hands on hips, flat back

1:00**EASY TRUNK TURNS**

Ball at chest, 10 each side, small to big

6 SAFETY RULES

- 1 Slam only a slam ball.** A rubber ball can bounce back into your face.
- 2 Throw at brick or concrete.** Not at drywall, glass or furniture.
- 3 Clear 2 × 2 metres.** Check for pets, toys and low lights before you start.
- 4 Call “ball!” before a partner throw.** Make eye contact, then throw.
- 5 Kids train with an adult.** The kids version is on page 10.
- 6 Stop with sharp pain.** Muscle burn is normal; joint pain is not.



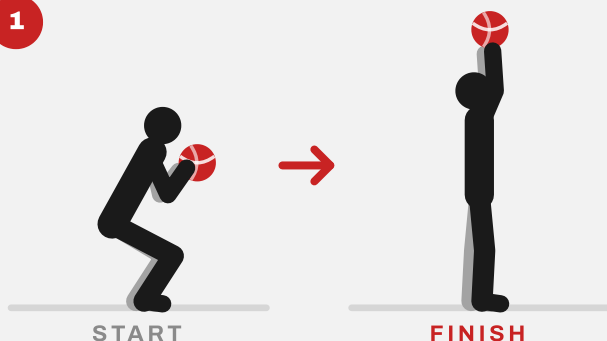
Breathe out on every throw, slam and chop. Holding your breath while bracing hard can spike blood pressure. A sharp exhale also helps you move faster.

HOW TO BRACE

Stand tall, then tighten your stomach as if someone is about to poke it. Keep that tension while you move. Your ribs stay stacked over your hips, and your lower back stays still while your hips and upper back do the turning.

THE MOVES

1



SQUAT TO PRESS

LEGS · GLUTES · SHOULDERS

8-12 REPS

- Hold the ball at your chest, elbows down.
- Sit your hips back until thighs are near parallel.
- Drive up and press the ball overhead in one move.

Tip: Breathe out as you press.

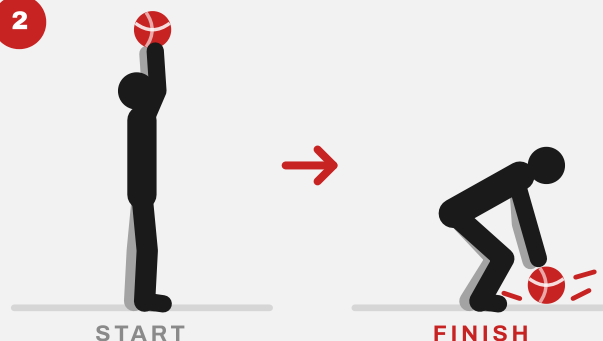
EASIER

Squat only, keep the ball at chest

HARDER

Pause 2 s at the bottom

2



BALL SLAM

FULL BODY · POWER

8-10 REPS

- Reach the ball overhead and rise onto your toes.
- Brace and throw it down just in front of your feet.
- Squat to pick it up with a flat back.

Tip: Look at the spot you'll slam, not at the ceiling.

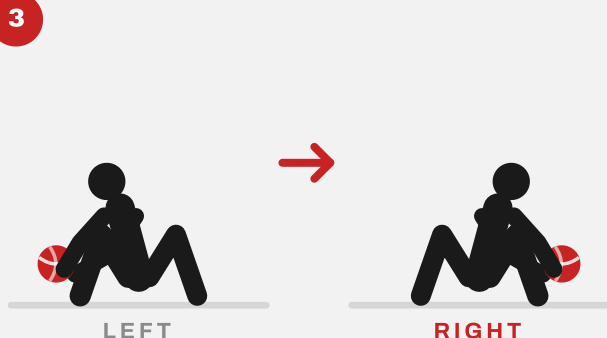
EASIER

Lighter ball, reset between reps

HARDER

Slam beside each foot, alternating

3



RUSSIAN TWIST

OBLIQUES · ABS

12-16 TOUCHES

- Sit tall, lean back slightly, heels on the floor.
- Turn your ribcage, not only your arms.
- Tap the ball beside each hip.

Tip: Your nose follows the ball. That keeps the turn in your upper back.

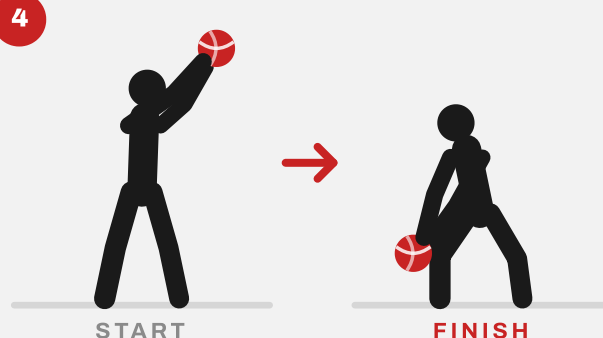
EASIER

Hold the ball closer to your chest

HARDER

Lift your feet off the floor

4



WOODCHOP

OBLIQUES · SHOULDERS · LEGS

8-10 / SIDE

- Start with the ball above one shoulder, arms long.
- Pull it diagonally to the opposite knee as you bend.
- Pivot the back foot to protect your lower back.

Tip: Move like you're chopping wood across your body.

EASIER

Half range: shoulder to hip

HARDER

Fast down, slow back up

MORE MOVES

5

START

FINISH

ROTATIONAL LUNGE

LEGS · GLUTES · OBLIQUES **8 / SIDE**

- Step forward into a lunge, both knees near 90°.
- Turn the ball over your front thigh.
- Bring it back to centre and push back to standing.

Tip: Front knee stays over your ankle, not past your toes.

EASIER

Split squat in place, no turn

HARDER

Walking lunges with the turn

6

LOAD

THROW

WALL CHEST PASS

CHEST · TRICEPS · POWER **10-15 REPS**

- Stand 1-1.5 m from a solid wall, one foot forward.
- Push the ball from your chest as fast as you can.
- Catch with soft elbows and reload.

Tip: Aim for one spot on the wall at chest height.

EASIER

Step closer, lighter ball

HARDER

Quarter squat before each throw

7

START

FINISH

DEAD BUG REACH

DEEP CORE **8-10 SLOW REPS**

- Lie on your back, ball over chest, knees at 90°.
- Reach the ball back as one leg straightens.
- Keep your lower back pressed into the floor.

Tip: Go slower than feels necessary: 3 s out, 3 s back.

EASIER

Move the ball only, legs still

HARDER

Straighten both legs

8

START

FINISH

SIT-TO-STAND

LEGS · GLUTES · BALANCE **8-12 REPS**

- Sit on the front half of a sturdy chair.
- Lean forward and stand without using your hands.
- Lower slowly, over 3 seconds, to touch the seat.

Tip: Push the floor away with your whole foot.

EASIER

Higher seat or add a cushion

HARDER

Hover 2 s just above the seat

WORKOUT
01

FULL-BODY CIRCUIT

20 MIN

40 S ON · 20 S OFF

3 ROUNDS

ALL LEVELS

Six moves, back to back. Work for 40 seconds, rest for 20, then move to the next exercise. Rest 60–90 seconds after each round.

40 s

20

40 s

20

40 s

20

40 s

20

40 s

20

40 s

20

One round = 6 minutes

1

SQUAT TO PRESS

Smooth rhythm; press on every rep. [Card 1](#)

40 s

2

ROTATIONAL LUNGE

Alternate legs each rep. [Card 5](#)

40 s

3

WALL CHEST PASS

Fast throws, soft catches. No wall? Do push-ups. [Card 6](#)

40 s

4

BALL SLAM

Slam ball only; otherwise swap for woodchops. [Card 2](#)

40 s

5

WOODCHOP

Switch sides each round. [Card 4](#)

40 s

6

RUSSIAN TWIST

Controlled turns, feet down. [Card 3](#)

40 s

BEGINNER

30 s on, 30 s off. 2 rounds.

STANDARD

40 s on, 20 s off. 3 rounds.

ADVANCED

45 s on, 15 s off. 4 rounds.

SWAP GUIDE

No wall? Push-ups or partner passes

Sore knees? Half squats, split squat instead of lunge

No slam ball? Fast woodchops

Low ceiling? Press to chin height, chop from shoulder

WORKOUT
02

CORE 15

15 MIN

REPS

3 ROUNDS

BEGINNER+

Slow, controlled reps for the deep core, then rotation, then one fast finisher. Rest 30 seconds between exercises and 1 minute between rounds.

1

DEAD BUG REACH

Lower back stays flat. Alternate legs. **Card 7**

10

reps

2

CRUNCH & REACH

Lie on your back, knees bent, ball on chest. Curl up and reach the ball toward your knees.

12

reps

3

RUSSIAN TWIST

Count one touch per side. **Card 3**

16

touches

4

PLANK BALL ROLL

In a push-up plank, roll the ball from one hand to the other without letting your hips sway.

10

rolls

5

WOODCHOP

Fast down, slow up. **Card 4**

8

per side

6

BALL SLAM FINISHER

Slam ball only; swap for 20 s of fast chops if you don't have one. **Card 2**

8

reps

WHY SLOW FIRST?

Control moves come first while you are fresh, so your lower back stays protected. Speed comes last, when the core is warm.

PROGRESS IT

Add 2 reps per exercise each week, or cut the rest between exercises to 15 seconds.

ROUNDS DONE:

☐ ROUND 1☐ ROUND 2☐ ROUND 3

WORKOUT
03

PARTNER & FAMILY

20 MIN

2+ PEOPLE

30 S EACH

FUN FIRST

Stand 2–3 metres apart, facing each other. Keep passing for 30 seconds per exercise. Count your passes and try to beat the total next round. Three rounds, 1 minute rest between.

1

CHEST PASS

Push from the chest to your partner's chest height.

30 s

2

SQUAT & PASS

Catch, squat, stand and pass. Partners take turns squatting.

30 s

3

SIDE TOSS

Stand side-on, turn from the hips and toss from hip height. Switch sides each round.

30 s

4

OVERHEAD THROW

Like a football throw-in: both hands, ball behind the head, step and throw.

30 s

5

SIT-UP PASS

Both partners sit, knees bent. Pass at the top of each sit-up.

30 s

6

BACK-TO-BACK PASS

Stand back to back, turn and hand the ball over. Switch direction halfway.

30 s

KIDS VERSION UNDER 12S

Use a 0.5–1 kg soft ball, 8–10 passes instead of 30 seconds, no slams, and an adult in every pair. Make it a game: tape a target on the wall and score points.

Family challenge: how many chest passes can your group make in 2 minutes without a drop? Write it down and beat it next week.

SCORE:

WORKOUT
04

STRONG AT 50+

20-25 MIN

2-3 SETS

60 S REST

LOW IMPACT

Keep a chair or counter within reach. Lift, stand or push **quickly**, then lower **slowly** over 3 seconds. That combination trains power as well as strength.³

1

SIT-TO-STANDStand up briskly, sit down slowly. **Card 8**

8-12

2

SEATED CHEST PUSH

Sit tall. Push the ball from chest to arm's length quickly, return slowly.

10-12

3

STANDING TRUNK TURN

Ball at chest, hips facing forward. Turn side to side at an easy pace.

8
per side

4

FRONT RAISE TO OVERHEAD

Lift the ball from hips to overhead, arms long. Lower over 3 seconds.

10

5

GENTLE WALL PASSStand an arm's length plus one step from the wall. Light, quick passes. **Card 6**

10

6

HEEL-TO-TOE BALANCE

Hold the ball at chest, one foot directly in front of the other, next to a counter.

20-30 s
each side**HOW OFTEN?**

Three days a week. The WHO advises older adults to combine balance and strength work on three or more days.⁴

BALL WEIGHT

Start with 1-2 kg. Move up only when every rep of every set feels controlled.

Stop and rest if you feel dizzy, short of breath or chest discomfort. If you take blood pressure medication or have a heart condition, get your doctor's OK first.

³ *Eur Rev Aging Phys Act* (2022) · ⁴ Bull et al., *WHO guidelines* (2020) · Go deeper: [Reps and sets for adults over 50](#)

IN CONVERSATION · SADIA BALOCH

ONE BALL, WHOLE FAMILY

How our head coach uses a single medicine ball to train clients at home, whole families, and adults over 50.

Q WHY A MEDICINE BALL FOR HOME TRAINING?

One piece of kit covers pushing, squatting, turning and throwing. It's small and it doesn't need a rack or a bench. Most people who train at home stop because setting up feels like a chore. A ball in the corner removes that excuse.

Q WHAT CAN IT DO THAT DUMBBELLS CAN'T?

You can throw it. Throwing teaches your body to produce force quickly, and that's the part of fitness daily life asks for most: lifting a case into an overhead bin, or getting up from the floor after playing with the kids.

Q HOW DO YOU GET FAMILIES TRAINING TOGETHER?

Make it a game. Count passes, not reps. Kids love a target, so I tape a square on the wall and let them aim at it. Parents end up working

harder than they planned because they're competing with a nine-year-old.

Q WHAT CHANGES FOR CLIENTS OVER 50?

Lighter ball, more control, and a chair nearby. We keep the lifting phase quick and the lowering slow. Balance is built into every session; a 20-second heel-to-toe hold with a ball is harder than it sounds.

Q WHEN DO PEOPLE NOTICE A DIFFERENCE?

Most clients tell me everyday things feel easier first: carrying shopping, getting off the floor. The mirror takes longer, which is why the log on page 15 matters.

Q ONE TIP FOR TODAY?

Put the ball where you'll see it. The easiest workout to start is the one already waiting in your living room.

THE COACH'S HOME SETUP

One 3–4 kg ball, one clear wall, one chair, a timer on your phone. Total floor space: about the size of a yoga mat and a half.

FAMILIES: START HERE

Do Workout 3 once a week on the weekend, then let kids pick one move from the cards for a 5-minute "bonus round."

28 DAYS

YOUR 4-WEEK PLAN

Pick one track. Each week the same workouts get a little harder, so you always know what “more” means.

TRACK A • SOLO OR FAMILY

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
WK 1	W1 2 rds	WALK	W2 2 rds	REST	W1 2 rds	W3 optional	REST
WK 2	W1 3 rds	WALK	W2 3 rds	REST	W1 3 rds	W3 optional	REST
WK 3	W1 3 rds · 45 s	WALK	W2 +2 reps	REST	W1 3 rds · 45 s	W3 optional	REST
WK 4	W1 4 rds	WALK	W2 15 s rest	REST	W1 4 rds	W3 optional	REST

TRACK B • 50+

	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
WK 1	W4 2 × 8	WALK	W4 2 × 8	WALK	W4 2 × 8	REST	REST
WK 2	W4 2 × 10	WALK	W4 2 × 10	WALK	W4 2 × 10	REST	REST
WK 3	W4 3 × 10	WALK	W4 3 × 10	WALK	W4 3 × 10	W3 with family	REST
WK 4	W4 3 × 12	WALK	W4 3 × 12	WALK	W4 3 × 12	W3 with family	REST

■ W1 Full body
 ■ W2 Core
 ■ W3 Partner (optional)
 ■ W4 Strong at 50+

After week 4: repeat the plan with a ball 1 kg heavier for strength moves, or keep the same ball and move up to the next level in each workout's “Advanced” option.

SPOT THEM EARLY

6 FORM MISTAKES

Most medicine ball injuries come from a few repeat errors. Check yourself against this page in week 1.

×

TWISTING FROM THE LOWER BACK

Turning only at the waist loads the lower spine.

Fix: Turn your ribcage and let your back foot pivot in chops and tosses.

×

ROUNDED BACK ON THE PICK-UP

Grabbing the ball after a slam with a curved back.

Fix: Squat down to it, chest up, then stand.

×

A SLOW, HEAVY THROW

If the ball floats, you are training strength, not power.

Fix: Go lighter until every throw is fast.

×

HOLDING YOUR BREATH

Bracing without breathing spikes pressure and slows you down.

Fix: Breathe out sharply on each throw or slam.

×

ARCHED BACK ON CORE MOVES

During dead bugs, the lower back lifts off the floor.

Fix: Shorten the reach until your back stays flat.

×

KNEES CAVING IN

In squats and lunges, knees drift toward each other.

Fix: Push knees out in line with your toes.

×

ROUNDED BACK

✓

FLAT BACK

PICKING THE BALL UP

After every slam, and at the start of every set. Bend your knees, keep your chest up, and lift with your legs.

Film one set a week.

Prop your phone at hip height, side-on. Compare it with the exercise cards on pages 6–7.

WORKOUT LOG

One row per session. Effort: 1 = easy, 5 = could not do more.

#	DATE	WORKOUT	BALL KG	ROUNDS / SETS	EFFORT	NOTES
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						
13						
14						
15						
16						
17						
18						
19						
20						

TEST YOURSELF · DAY 1 VS DAY 28

30-SECOND WALL PASSES

Count clean chest passes in 30 seconds.

30-SECOND SIT-TO-STAND

Count full stands from a chair in 30 seconds, arms across your chest.

YOU ASKED

HOW OFTEN SHOULD I TRAIN?

Two or three times a week on non-consecutive days. Workout 4 works best three times a week.

NO WALL AT HOME?

Pass with a partner, or lie on your back and press the ball straight up, catching it on the way down.

WILL THIS HELP WITH FAT LOSS?

Circuits raise your heart rate and build muscle, which helps. Fat loss depends mostly on your overall diet and daily activity. [Reps and sets for fat loss](#)

IS IT SAFE FOR KIDS?

Supervised resistance training is considered safe for children when the load is light and technique comes first.⁵

MY LOWER BACK ACHES AFTER TWISTS.

Stop twists for a week, then return with feet on the floor and a smaller range. If it continues, see a professional.

CAN I COMBINE THIS WITH GYM TRAINING?

Yes. Use Workout 2 after a gym session, or Workout 1 on a day you can't get to the gym.

WHICH WORKOUT SHOULD I START WITH?

New to training: Workout 2 at the beginner level for a week, then add Workout 1. Over 50: start with Workout 4.

CAN I DO TWO WORKOUTS IN ONE DAY?

Yes, if they're different. Workout 1 plus Workout 2 makes a 35-minute session; skip the core finisher slams.

SOURCES

- 1 Ignjatovic AM, et al. Effects of 12-week medicine ball training on muscle strength and power in young female handball players. *J Strength Cond Res*. 2012. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/22027860
- 2 Raeder C, et al. Effects of six weeks of medicine ball training on throwing velocity, throwing precision, and isokinetic strength of shoulder rotators in female handball players. *J Strength Cond Res*. 2015. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/26102258
- 3 Effectiveness of power training compared to strength training in older adults: a systematic review and meta-analysis. *Eur Rev Aging Phys Act*. 2022. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/35953775
- 4 Bull FC, et al. World Health Organization 2020 guidelines on physical activity and sedentary behaviour. *Br J Sports Med*. 2020. pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33239350
- 5 Faigenbaum AD, et al. Youth resistance training: updated position statement paper from the NSCA. *J Strength Cond Res*. 2009. journals.lww.com/nsca-jscr

Please note: this collection is general information, not medical advice. If you have an injury, a heart condition or balance problems, or you are returning to exercise after a long break, check with your doctor first.

KEEP GOING

MORE MEDICINE BALL GUIDES, FREE

Every body part, every level. At exercisemenu.com.

10 MOVES FOR LEGS

With sets and reps



10 CHEST EXERCISES

Strength and power



10 MOVES FOR YOUR BACK

No gym needed



10 MOVES FOR SHOULDERS

Press, hold, throw



10 MOVES FOR ARMS

Biceps, triceps, shoulders



THE COMPLETE GUIDE

Every medicine ball exercise



ALSO IN THIS SERIES

ISSUE 01

**THE BEGINNER'S COMPLETE
TRAINING FOUNDATION**

ISSUE 02

**THE 12-WEEK PROGRESSIVE
OVERLOAD WORKBOOK**

COMING NEXT · ISSUE 04

**PLATEAU BREAKER: THE 8-WEEK INTERMEDIATE
PLAN**



Print & pin: the exercise cards (pages 6–7) on the wall where you train, the 4-week plan (page 13) on the fridge, and the log (page 15) next to your ball.

SEND THIS COLLECTION TO YOUR INBOX

Share it with a training partner: exercisemenu.com